

Dr. Asif Iqbal: A Global Voice for Economic Diplomacy and Strategic Trade Relations



Asif Iqbal, President, Indian Economic Trade Organization (IETO) - Kopie

In a rapidly evolving global economy, where international collaboration and strategic partnerships define success, few figures have emerged as consistently impactful as Dr. Asif Iqbal. A highly regarded expert in economic diplomacy, Dr. Iqbal is known for his leadership in strengthening India's global trade footprint and creating sustainable frameworks for international cooperation. As the President of the Indian Economic Trade Organization (IETO), he has championed the cause of inclusive growth, global engagement, and cross-border partnerships.

With a career spanning over two decades, Dr. Iqbal has been instrumental in forging strong trade and cultural ties between India and over 70 countries. His work is rooted in a deep understanding of international economic systems, diplomacy, and development. Under his stewardship, IETO has grown into one of India's most active platforms for economic engagement, regularly organizing trade delegations, diplomatic dialogues, investment summits, and business conclaves aimed at fostering mutual growth.

What sets Dr. Iqbal apart is his unique ability to bring together stakeholders from government, industry, academia, and civil society. He has successfully bridged the gap

between policy and practice, enabling meaningful collaborations that extend beyond commerce to include education, healthcare, technology, and sustainability. His vision for trade diplomacy is holistic—focused not just on business deals, but on empowering communities, promoting entrepreneurship, and fostering innovation.

A skilled negotiator and communicator, Dr. Iqbal has led several high-level delegations to countries across the Gulf, Africa, Central Asia, and Europe. These missions have often resulted in the signing of bilateral agreements, joint ventures, and investment opportunities that support India's global ambitions. He has also played a key role in connecting Indian MSMEs and startups to international markets, helping them navigate foreign regulatory environments and cultural nuances with confidence.

Dr. Iqbal's influence extends to academic and diplomatic circles as well. He is a regular participant at international forums, think tanks, and policy dialogues where he advocates for stronger South-South cooperation, capacity building, and knowledge exchange. He has been honored by multiple governments and organizations for his contributions to diplomacy and economic development, a testament to the respect he

commands globally. Among his many strengths are his ability to think strategically, act decisively, and build long-term relationships based on trust and mutual respect. He has a rare talent for identifying synergies between diverse sectors and geographies, and turning these into tangible partnerships. His inclusive approach—often bringing together women leaders, young entrepreneurs, and marginalized voices—reflects his belief that true progress is only possible when growth is broad-based and equitable.

Beyond the boardrooms and summits, Dr. Iqbal remains deeply committed to humanitarian and social causes. He has been involved in several initiatives that promote education, skill development, and women empowerment in underserved regions. His leadership reflects a balance of pragmatism and idealism—a drive to create global impact while remaining rooted in values.

As the world becomes increasingly interconnected, the need for seasoned professionals like Dr. Asif Iqbal—who can navigate complexity with clarity and build bridges between nations—is more critical than ever. His work not only uplifts Indian businesses on the global stage but also redefines how diplomacy and trade can work together to build a more inclusive and prosperous world.